

SCALER

Brief for your next step

Hey Rohan, good speaking with you today. Your point about not wanting to go from 14 LPA at TCS to 16 LPA at another service company stuck with me -- that is exactly the right way to frame this decision, and I want to give you straight answers.

Your questions answered

1

What does Rs. 3.5L actually buy that Andrew Ng does not?

Andrew Ng is genuinely excellent for concepts -- no argument there. The gap is everything around the content: live classes 3x a week with industry instructors, a dedicated 1:1 mentor who is an active practitioner (not a TA), and 50+ hands-on projects that force you to ship, not just watch. Coursera does not follow up when you go quiet for two weeks, does not run mock interviews with live AI avatars, and does not connect you to 900+ hiring partners who already trust Scaler's filter. For a self-starter who just needs content, free wins. For someone trying to make a hard pivot from 4 years of TCS banking work into product AI roles, the structure, accountability, and recruiter access are the actual product.

2

Realistic salary outcome for someone at your profile -- not a generic number

I will be straight with you: I cannot quote you a personal salary guarantee, and anyone who does on a first call is making things up. What Scaler publishes is a median salary hike of around 110% for the DS/ML track -- that is the only verified figure I have in front of me right now. Whether that maps to your specific profile (4 YoE, TCS SDE-2, AWS cert, targeting AI engineering at product companies) depends on role, city, and the companies you interview with. What I can say is that the program is built for the 0-7 YoE bracket, so you are not going to be the most experienced person in the room. For benchmarks tied to your exact background and target companies, the admissions team can walk you through alumni outcomes that actually match -- I would rather you hear that on the next call than get a number from me that turns out to be wrong.

3

RAG, agents, evals -- is it real or is it just theory?

This one I can answer directly because it is in the curriculum: the program explicitly covers Prompt Engineering, RAG, and Multi-agent orchestration under the AI and Agents module, plus an Agentic AI elective. That is not a theoretical ML statistics course -- it is the applied LLM stack you said you want to build on. Your AWS Solutions Architect background actually sets you up well here because a lot of production RAG and agent work lives on cloud infra you already understand. Exact project briefs and how deep the evals component goes are things admissions can show you in detail on the next call.

4

One honest thing about the entrance test

The entrance test is required before enrollment -- it is not a formality, it gates the second call and your seat. Given that you have a B.Tech CSE from VIT and 4 years of active engineering, you are not walking in cold. Think of it less as a barrier and more as the thing that ensures your cohort is at your level, which is actually in your interest. Specific retake rules and any prep resources available to you are confirmed by admissions -- happy to share those details on your next call so you know exactly what to expect.

Today

Your current compensation depends on role and city. Happy to personalize on your next call.

Target path

Stronger product and tech-facing roles depend on effort and market. We share realistic bands with admissions, not guesses.

NOW

Skills audit & entrance clarity

0-4 MO

Core foundations & habits

4-8 MO

Depth projects & design

8-12 MO

Interview readiness

Take the entrance test when you are ready -- it is the one step that unlocks everything else, and your engineering background puts you in a solid position.

Prepared for Rohan Sharma · 08 May 2026 · Scaler Academy